

Find users with largest storage usage

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Displays the top 10 users on the system by storage consumption in their home directories, sorted in descending order by disk usage.

Language

bash

Category

disk-usage

Command

```
du -sh /home/* 2>/dev/null | sort -hr | head -10
```

Explanation

The command uses 'du -sh' to calculate the total disk usage in human-readable format for each home directory. The '2>/dev/null' suppresses permission denied errors for inaccessible directories. The output is piped to 'sort -hr' to sort in descending order (largest first) using human-readable number comparison. Finally, 'head -10' limits the output to the top 10 users.

Tags

disk-usage, storage, users, system-administration, du, sort

Dependencies

coreutils, findutils

Arguments

1. **PATH** (Optional): Home directory path to analyze (default: /home)
Default: /home
2. **COUNT** (Optional): Number of top users to display (default: 10)
Default: 10

Examples

1. `du -sh /home/* 2>/dev/null | sort -hr | head -10` - Show top 10 users by storage usage in /home
2. `du -sh /home/* 2>/dev/null | sort -hr` - Show all users sorted by storage usage without limit
3. `du -sh /home/* 2>/dev/null | sort -hr | head -5` - Show top 5 users by storage usage
4. `du -sh /root /home/* 2>/dev/null | sort -hr | head -10` - Include root's home directory in the analysis

Output

```
450G    /home/alice
320G    /home/bob
215G    /home/charlie
156G    /home/diana
98G     /home/eve
67G     /home/frank
45G     /home/grace
32G     /home/henry
28G     /home/iris
19G     /home/jack
```

Notes

- The command suppresses permission errors with `'2>/dev/null'`, allowing users to see results without elevated privileges
- Human-readable format (`-h`) displays sizes in K, M, G, etc., making interpretation easier
- Sort with `-h` flag properly handles human-readable numbers (not lexicographic sorting)
- Symbolic links in `/home` are counted separately if they point outside `/home`
- Hidden files and directories within user homes are included in the totals
- Results may vary if some home directories are mounted on different filesystems

Warnings

- Results may be incomplete if you lack read permissions on certain home directories
- On systems with many users, this command may take considerable time to complete
- NFS-mounted or slow storage may cause noticeable delays

See Also

- `find-large-files-recursive`
- `disk-space-usage-per-directory`

Status

reviewed

Safety

safe

Shell

bash

Platforms

linux, gnu-linux, freebsd

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